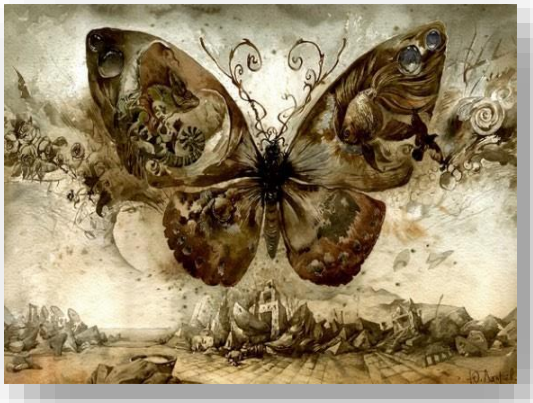
CNEAP 402 COURSEWORK ESSAY TASK SHEET, Semester 2, 2026

LOGISTICS AND SUPPLY CHAIN MANAGEMENT GRP



Essay Title: *Analyse the Key Drivers and Strategic Implications of SME Supplier Development in Modern Supply Chains*

Assigned: *Week 1*

Essay Type: *Cause-Effect Academic Essay*

Weight:

- **15%** of your final CNMSCI573 (Operations and Supply Chain Excellence) grade
- **30%** of your final CNEAP402 grade

COURSEWORK OVERVIEW

This coursework requires a cause–effect academic essay that critically examines the drivers of SME supplier development and evaluates their strategic implications for supply chain management. Students must demonstrate the ability to analyse causal relationships and synthesise academic research with real-world examples.

HOW YOUR ESSAY WILL BE ASSESSED

This assignment will be evaluated by the convenor of CNEAP402 according to the criteria listed below:

1. **Academic Content and Subject Knowledge** *This includes your ability to demonstrate:*

- Clear understanding and accurate application of key concepts related to SME supplier development and supply chain strategy
- Integration and synthesis of relevant academic literature
- Clear cause–effect reasoning linking drivers to strategic implications
- Depth of critical analysis beyond descriptive explanation
- Effective use of real-world examples to support and illustrate arguments

2. **Academic English and Communication Skills** *This includes your ability to:*

- Present ideas clearly, accurately, and in an appropriate academic register
- Structure the essay logically with a coherent introduction, developed body paragraphs, and a focused conclusion
- Construct well-developed paragraphs with clear topic sentences and evidence-based argumentation
- Use summarising and paraphrasing appropriately
- Maintain cohesion and logical progression throughout
- Apply Lancaster Harvard referencing accurately and consistently

ASSIGNMENT BRIEF

This essay focuses on the causes (drivers) of supplier development, and should be structured to cover:

a) Extended Definition: The first body paragraph must be comprised of a clear, extended definition of SME supplier development within the context of global logistics and supply chain management.

b) The Drivers: Identify and explain the primary factors forcing changes in this area. You should synthesize research on key drivers such as digital transformation, cost efficiency strategies, sustainability goals, regulatory pressures or regional supply chain disruptions due to global crises.

c) Strategic Implications: Discuss how these drivers influence broader supply chain strategy and collaboration.

Real-world examples or industry cases must be used to support your arguments. As requested in CNMSCI573, you are not allowed to select organizations that have been discussed extensively in CNMSCI573, e.g. Toyota, Ford Motors, etc. You are encouraged to reflect on variations across different sectors or regions where appropriate.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

The use of generative AI tools (for example ChatGPT, Grammarly Premium, or similar software) for drafting, editing, paraphrasing, idea generation, or translation is strictly prohibited.

Use of such tools will be treated as a breach of Lancaster University's academic integrity policy.

You must sign the declaration on the cover page to confirm compliance.

GENERAL GUIDELINES

Formatting Requirements

- You must incorporate the EAP402 Coursework Essay Cover Page at the beginning of your essay (see page 4)
- The essay should be between 900 and 1,200 words in length (excluding any figures or tables).
- Insert page numbers at the bottom of each page.
- You should use Times New Roman or Arial font in either 11-point or 12-point size.
- Use 1.5 or double line spacing.
- The essay must be written in continuous academic prose without subheadings or bullet points.

Figures and Tables

- The inclusion of figures and/or tables is optional for this essay.
- Each figure and table should be clearly numbered and titled and must be explicitly mentioned within the paragraph (i.e. not just appear).
- Do not reproduce any figures or tables; only use them if you have adapted them and synthesised different elements.

Citation and Referencing

- Use Lancaster University Harvard referencing system as detailed on the CNEAP402 Moodle page.
- Every citation must have a corresponding reference and vice versa.
- Use summarising and paraphrasing effectively. Direct quotations should not exceed 10% of the total word count.
- You must cite a minimum of 5 high-quality academic sources in English, of which at least 3 should be peer-reviewed journal articles. Professional industry reports, white papers, or government publications may supplement journal sources but cannot replace them.

You must annotate three of your academic sources. For each selected source:

- Highlight or underline key points
- Write brief notes in the margins
- Include the annotated pages at the end of your submission

These annotated pages are not included in the word count.

Do Not (×)

- Use any bullet points
- Write paragraphs that are underdeveloped. A paragraph generally consists of 5–8 sentences that explore a topic with supporting evidence.
- Submit a report. This task must be written as a properly structured academic essay

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

- Draft Submission: Week 6 (by 23:59 on the date to be confirmed)
- Submit your essay as a Word document via the EAP 402 Moodle page. Submissions cannot be accepted via WeChat or email, and PDF files are not allowed.
- Final submission: Week 8 (by 23:59 on the date to be confirmed). The name of your file should be: 'Coursework Essay Final' - *your student number* - *your name in Pinyin*'

- Your submission must have the EAP402 Coursework Essay Cover Page at the beginning of your document, showing your Chinese name, English name, student number, class number, date and declaration.

Late submission penalties:

- 5% deduction: More than 24 hours late
- 10% deduction: More than 36 hours late

Note: Only medical exemptions with a valid doctor's note will be accepted.

CNEAP402: Coursework Essay Cover Page

Programme:	English for Academic Purposes – Master's Programme
Module:	EAP 402
Chinese Name:	
English Name:	
Student Number:	
Class:	
Essay Title:	
Word Count	
Date of Submission	

Declaration of Academic Integrity

I declare that this essay is entirely my own work and has been produced without the assistance of generative AI tools (including but not limited to ChatGPT, Grammarly Premium, or similar). I understand that the use of such tools violates Lancaster University's academic integrity policy and may result in academic penalties.

Signed: ……

Date: …….